

WASP

Buzziest hero of the Avengers team



Janet Van Dyne was with her scientist father Vernon when he visited Dr. Henry Pym to ask him to collaborate on a project to use an energy beam to detect signals from extraterrestrial civilizations. Pym declined, but was attracted to Janet, who reminded him of his late wife Maria. Van Dyne proceeded with his experiment. However, a criminal from the Kosmosian race tracked Van Dyne's beam to Earth and murdered him.



The Wasp's bioelectric "stings" can inflict pain on even superhumanly strong foes.

PYM PARTICLES

Janet told Pym she was determined to bring her father's killer to justice. Pym revealed his dual identity as Ant-Man and offered to endow her with superhuman abilities and make her his crimefighting partner. Janet agreed and became the Wasp. Pym taught her to use gas containing subatomic "Pym particles" to shrink herself and regain normal size. He also implanted cells beneath her shoulder blades that enabled her to grow wings at insect size. Ant-Man and the Wasp duly defeated the "creature from Kosmo."

Pym and Janet also fell in love. It was Pym who suggested that he, the Wasp, the Hulk, Iron Man, and Thor band together, and Janet who suggested the name "THE AVENGERS."

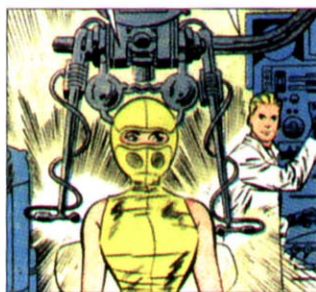
A STORMY MARRIAGE

Pym adopted other costumed identities, Giant-Man and Goliath, and then an alternate, aggressive personality named Yellowjacket. Realizing that he was still Pym, Janet married him anyway, and he soon regained his true personality. Pym later had a nervous breakdown, and he and Janet were divorced; however time healed the rift and they became friends, and eventually lovers again.

After the CIVIL WAR (see pp. 84-5), the Wasp joined Iron Man's team of pro-registration Avengers. She fought the SKRULLS during the SECRET INVASION (see pp. 326-7) and was stunned to learn that a Skrull had been posing as Pym for months. After Queen VERANKE was killed, the Skrull Pym turned the Wasp into a fast-growing bio-bomb, and THOR had to kill her to keep her from detonating. Recently, Pym took to calling himself the Wasp in his wife's honor

PS, MF

Janet Van Dyne briefly used her size-changing powers to grow to gigantic size, but soon went back to fighting evil as the Wasp.



Pym implanted cells in Janet that would enable her to grow antennae to communicate with insects. The antennae coils died early in her career.



The fun-loving Wasp enjoyed teasing her partner Henry Pym, here in Giant-Man mode.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Janet Van Dyne

OCCUPATION

Adventurer, fashion designer

BASE

Avengers Mansion, New York City; Cresskill, New Jersey; later Oxford, England

HEIGHT 5 ft 4 in

WEIGHT 110 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Auburn

FIRST APPEARANCE

Tales to Astonish #44 (June 1963)

Ability to shrink in size down to a half inch in height. When the Wasp is 4 ft. 2 in. or less in height, wings appear from her body, enabling her to fly. Can discharge bioelectric force bolts from her hands.

WASP

POWERS

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Avengers #59-60

Janet Van Dyne marries Henry Pym in his new Yellowjacket identity.

• **Avengers #214-219** Janet Van Dyne divorces Henry Pym and becomes Avengers chairman.

• **Avengers #270-277** In her final mission as chairman, Wasp leads Avengers in thwarting Masters of Evil's takeover of Avengers Mansion.

